

YEAR 10 (AFTER PREP) · THEME 1 · SPORTS

Reading

B1+/B2

Born for the Rush? · Oil, Honour and Forty Springs

Hazırlık Sonrası 10. Sınıf

Name – Surname

Class

No

Date

Aim Understand the main idea and details, make inferences and connect the text to your own life.

1 Before you read

Make predictions before you read.

1. Look at the title. What do you think 'born for the rush' means?
2. Do you know anyone who loves risky or exciting activities? What are they like?

Born for the Rush?

- 1 Why do some people happily jump out of aeroplanes or ride down a mountain on a board, while others would never dream of it? Decades ago, a psychologist proposed that certain people are simply wired to seek out risk. He called them 'Type T' individuals — the 'T' standing for thrill. According to his theory, these people don't just tolerate danger; they actively look for it.
- 2 Scientists who study this idea point to biology as one possible explanation. Type T brains may release dopamine, the chemical linked to pleasure, more strongly during risky activities than an average person's brain does. This could explain why a thrill-seeker's heart races with excitement, not fear, the moment a parachute opens.
- 3 Critics warn against judging every risk-taker as reckless, however. Many so-called Type T people take up creative or entrepreneurial paths instead of dangerous sports, channelling the same hunger for novelty into painting, invention or starting a business. Whether on a cliff edge or in a studio, it seems the same restless curiosity can drive very different kinds of lives.

176 words

2 While you read

5 × 2 pts

Circle the correct option.

- What is the main idea of the text?
 - Only dangerous sports attract Type T people.
 - Some people may be biologically drawn to risk and novelty, which can show up in different ways.
 - Dopamine makes all risky sports completely safe.
 - The psychologist called risk-seeking people _____ individuals.
 - According to the text, what chemical might explain a thrill-seeker's excitement?
 - adrenaline only
 - dopamine
 - stamina
 - According to the text, all Type T people become extreme athletes. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
-
- The final paragraph suggests that the same restless curiosity can drive people toward risky sports or toward _____ paths.

3 After you read*Write short answers. Then compare with a partner.*

- Do you think you have a 'Type T' personality? Why or why not?

- Can you think of another non-sporting way someone might channel a love of risk?

1 Before you read*Make predictions before you read.*

- What do you already know about traditional Turkish sports?

- What do you think the name 'Kırkpınar' might mean?

Oil, Honour and Forty Springs

- Every July, thousands of spectators travel to Edirne to watch one of the oldest sporting events in the world. Wrestlers, known as pehlivan, cover their bodies in olive oil and compete on open grass in leather trousers called a kispet. The tournament, known as Kırkpınar, has been held almost every year since 1924, making it a proud symbol of Turkish sporting heritage.

- 2 The event's name comes from an old legend. Two brothers are said to have wrestled each other for so long, and so evenly matched, that neither could win — until, exhausted, they both collapsed and died on the spot. According to the story, forty springs later bubbled up from the ground where they fell, giving the region its name: Kirkpınar, or 'Forty Springs'.
- 3 Beyond the oil and the crowds, Kirkpınar is built on respect. Wrestlers bow to their opponents before a match, and the strongest competitor, the başpehlivan, is expected to show humility, not arrogance. Similar values appear in other traditional Turkish sports, such as the horseback javelin game, where courage and fair play matter as much as winning.

181 words

2 While you read

5 × 2 pts

Circle the correct option.

1. Where does the Kirkpınar tournament take place?
a Istanbul b Edirne c Ankara
2. Wrestlers in Kirkpınar are known as _____.
3. According to the legend, the two brothers both won the wrestling match. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
-
4. What quality is the başpehlivan (strongest wrestler) expected to show?
a arrogance b humility c impatience
5. The text says courage and _____ matter as much as winning in the traditional javelin game.

3 After you read

Write short answers. Then compare with a partner.

1. Why do you think respect and humility are so important in this sport?
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-
2. Compare Kirkpınar with a modern sport you know — what values do they share or not share?
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